Q1 [1 Mark] Identify the place where the secret underground society named 'Young Europe' was founded by Mazzini:

- (A) Berne
- (B) Brussels
- (C) Marseilles
- (D) Vienna

Answer: (A) Berne

- **NCERT Point:** Giuseppe Mazzini founded two underground societies: first, *Young Italy* in Marseilles, and subsequently *Young Europe* in Berne, bringing together like-minded young men from Poland, France, Italy, and the German states.

Q2 [5 Marks]

How did nationalism, aligned with imperialism, lead Europe to disaster in 1914? Explain with examples.

Answer:

1. **Transformation of Nationalism:** After 1871, nationalism lost its idealistic, liberal-democratic character and turned into a narrow, aggressive creed where nationalist groups became increasingly intolerant and prone to conflict.
2. **The Balkan Powder Keg:** The most severe source of nationalist tension in Europe after 1871 was the Balkans—a region of great ethnic and geographic diversity ruled by the rapidly declining Ottoman Empire.
3. **Spread of Romantic Nationalism:** The spread of romantic nationalist ideas, combined with the disintegration of the Ottoman Empire, made the Balkan region intensely volatile as various Slavic nationalities fought to establish their independence.
4. **Mutual Hostility Among Balkan States:** As individual Balkan states struggled to define their identity and borders, they developed fierce rivalries and sought to conquer additional territory at the direct expense of their neighbours.
5. **Big-Power Imperial Rivalry:** Major European powers (Russia, Germany, Great Britain, and Austria-Hungary) competed intensely over trade, overseas colonies, and naval and military supremacy; each power manipulated Balkan nationalism to advance its own imperialist goals, which led to a series of regional wars and finally culminated in the First World War in 1914.

Q3 [1 Mark] Choose the correct option to fill in the blank: The Indus Valley Civilization was linked to the _____ region through coastal trade as early as 3000 BCE.

- (A) North America
- (B) South America
- (C) West Asia
- (D) South Australia

Answer: (C) West Asia

- **NCERT Point:** An active coastal trade network connected the Indus Valley Civilisation with present-day West Asia from as early as 3000 BCE.

Q4 [1 Mark] Two statements labelled as Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are given below. Read both the statements carefully and choose the correct option:

- **Assertion (A):** The Portuguese and Spanish conquest and colonisation of America was decisively under way by the mid-sixteenth century.
- **Reason (R):** The Spanish conquerors had the most powerful conventional weapons.

Options:

- (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A).
- (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true, but Reason (R) is *not* the correct explanation of Assertion (A).
- (C) Assertion (A) is true, but Reason (R) is false.
- (D) Assertion (A) is false, but Reason (R) is true.

Answer: (C) Assertion (A) is true, but Reason (R) is false.

- **NCERT Point:** The Spanish conquest was not primarily achieved through superior conventional military firepower; their most destructive weapon was biological—namely deadly germs such as smallpox, against which native Americans possessed no natural immunity.

Q5 [1 Mark] Arrange the following events of 'print culture' in chronological order and choose the correct option:

- I. Publication of 'Sambad Kaumudi'
- II. Publication of weekly magazine 'Bengal Gazette'
- III. 'Vernacular Press Act' was implemented
- IV. The first printed edition of the *'Ramcharitmanas'*

Options:

- (A) III, I, IV, II
- (B) III, I, II, IV
- (C) II, IV, III, I
- (D) II, IV, I, III

Answer: (D) II, IV, I, III

- **NCERT Chronological Timeline:**
    1. **II.** Weekly magazine *Bengal Gazette* started publication by James Augustus Hickey (**1780**).
    2. **IV.** First printed edition of Tulsidas's *Ramcharitmanas* published in Calcutta (**1810**).
    3. **I.** Rammohan Roy published the *Sambad Kaumudi* (**1821**).
    4. **III.** The *Vernacular Press Act* was passed by the colonial government (**1878**).

Q6 [1 Mark] oldest printed book in Japan?

- (A) Diamond Sutra
- (B) Tripitaka Koreana
- (C) Japanese Bible
- (D) Ukiyo

Answer: (A) Diamond Sutra *(Printed in 868 CE)*

Q 7 [3 Marks]
"Printing is the ultimate gift of God and the greatest one." Analyse the statement.
Answer:

1. **Origin of the *Ninety-Five Theses*:** In 1517, the religious reformer Martin Luther wrote the *Ninety-Five Theses*, severely criticizing corrupt practices and rituals within the Roman Catholic Church.
2. **Challenging Church Dogma:** A printed copy of the text was posted on the church door

at Wittenberg, openly inviting the Church to engage in public debate over his theological objections.

3. **Rapid Mass Circulation:** Gutenberg's movable-type printing press allowed Luther's writings to be reproduced instantly in vast numbers and distributed widely across Europe.
4. **Sparking the Protestant Reformation:** Luther's German translation of the New Testament sold 5,000 copies within mere weeks, leading directly to an ideological split inside the Church and inaugurating the Protestant Reformation.
5. **Gratitude Toward the Press:** Recognizing that print had fostered a new intellectual climate that democratized knowledge and spread reformist thought, Luther gratefully declared print to be "the ultimate gift of God and the greatest one".